

Checklist:

What Is Management?

Core job

- ☐ Focus on getting **better outcomes from a group of people working together**
- ☐ Remember that a team can achieve **more than one person alone**
- ☐ Aim to create a **multiplier effect**, not just add your own individual output
- ☐ Improve the team's **purpose, people, and process**

Purpose

- ☐ Make sure the team knows **what success looks like**
- ☐ Make sure the team understands **why the work matters**
- ☐ Check that people **care about achieving** the goal
- ☐ Reinforce purpose in meetings, goals, and day-to-day communication

People

- ☐ Build a team that **works well together**
- ☐ Support team members in **reaching career goals**
- ☐ Hire and develop people well
- ☐ Keep an eye on **team happiness and satisfaction**
- ☐ Make sure people have the **right skills** for the work
- ☐ Make sure people are **motivated**
- ☐ Build trusting relationships with team members
- ☐ Understand each person's **strengths and weaknesses**
- ☐ Give individuals what they need to do their best work

Process

- ☐ Create processes that help work move **smoothly and efficiently**
- ☐ Clarify **who should do what**
- ☐ Define **how decisions should be made**
- ☐ Run effective meetings
- ☐ Learn from past mistakes

- ☐ Plan for tomorrow, not just today
- ☐ Help create and maintain a healthy team culture

How to judge your management

- ☐ Evaluate yourself by your team's **results**, not just your activity
- ☐ Look at your team's **present outcomes**
- ☐ Look at whether your team is set up for **great future outcomes**
- ☐ Ask: "Am I creating valuable, easy-to-use, well-crafted work through this team?"
- ☐ Ask: "Am I building a strong, satisfied team?"

Personal approach

- ☐ Spend less time doing the work yourself and more time **enabling others**
- ☐ **Avoid** acting only as an **individual contributor**
- ☐ Adapt to what the **team** and organization **need**
- ☐ Accept that much of management work is **unglamorous but necessary**
- ☐ **Inspire people** to act, rather than just telling them what to do
- ☐ Build **trust** and **respect** so people want to follow you

Self-check before becoming or staying a manager

- ☐ Do I enjoy the **day-to-day work of management**?
- ☐ Am I **motivated by helping** a team achieve an outcome?
- ☐ Am I comfortable spending a lot of time **talking with people**?
- ☐ Can I provide stability in **emotionally challenging situations**?
- ☐ Am I willing to **adapt** into the leader my team needs?